

Website Design Specification

Interactive Travel Planner - Visual Identity & UI Design

Project:	Travel Planner Web Application
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1. Design Philosophy

The travel planner website should blend the clean, user-centric design of Airbnb with the immersive visual storytelling of luxury travel sites. The aesthetic should feel modern, trustworthy, and inviting, using sophisticated color choices, elevated neutrals, and gentle gradient transitions to create a calming yet engaging experience. The design should prioritize clarity and conversion while maintaining visual elegance.

2. Unique Color Palette

The color palette is inspired by 2026 design trends featuring elevated neutrals, soft jewel tones, and adaptive gradients. This palette balances warmth with sophistication, creating a sense of trust and wanderlust.

Color Name	Hex Code	Usage	Sample
Sage Horizon	#8B9D83	Primary brand color, CTAs, active states	
Terracotta Dusk	#C07856	Accent color, highlights, hover states	
Deep Ocean	#2D5A7B	Secondary actions, trust elements	
Warm Sand	#F5EDE0	Background, cards, elevated surfaces	
Soft Lavender	#B8A8D8	Interactive elements, badges, alerts	
Mocha Neutral	#948B82	Text, borders, subtle elements	
Pure Cream	#FDFBF7	Main background, white space	
Charcoal Depth	#2C3033	Headings, primary text	

3. Background Design

Background Strategy:

The background should use subtle gradient transitions and elevated neutral tones to create depth without distraction. Inspired by luxury travel sites and modern UI trends, the background combines soft color shifts with strategic white space.

Primary Background Options:

- **Gradient Hero Section:** Gentle vertical gradient from Warm Sand (#F5EDE0) at top to Pure Cream (#FDFBF7) at bottom, creating a warm, welcoming entry point
- **Main Content Area:** Pure Cream (#FDFBF7) with subtle noise texture (2-3% opacity) for depth
- **Card Backgrounds:** White (#FFFFFF) with soft shadow (0px 2px 8px rgba(0,0,0,0.06)) for elevation
- **Interactive Sections:** Soft radial gradient from center, transitioning Soft Lavender to Warm Sand with 15% opacity overlay

4. Typography

Element	Font	Size/Weight	Color
Headings (H1)	Inter Bold	36-48px / 700	Charcoal Depth (#2C3033)
Headings (H2)	Inter Semibold	28-32px / 600	Charcoal Depth (#2C3033)
Headings (H3)	Inter Medium	20-24px / 500	Deep Ocean (#2D5A7B)
Body Text	Inter Regular	16px / 400	Mocha Neutral (#948B82)
Button Text	Inter Medium	16px / 500	Pure Cream (#FDFBF7)
Captions	Inter Regular	14px / 400	Mocha Neutral (#948B82)

5. Design Inspiration Sources

The design draws from best-in-class travel websites and 2026 UI trends to create a unique, conversion-focused experience.

Source	What to Borrow	How to Apply
Airbnb	Clean navigation, personalized content, smooth scrolling	Simplify the first interface with clear CTAs
Booking.com	User-friendly layout, efficient navigation, trust signals	Clear lines, intuitive filters, review badges
Luxury Travel Sites	Elevated imagery, sophisticated palette, editorial tone	Maximize style cards with high-quality photos
2026 UI Trends	Adaptive colors, soft gradients, elevated neutrals	Dynamic backgrounds that shift based on context

6. Key UI Components

6.1 Navigation Bar

- Background: Pure Cream (#FDFBF7) with subtle bottom border (Warm Sand)
- Logo: Sage Horizon (#8B9D83) with custom travel icon
- Menu items: Mocha Neutral (#948B82), hover to Sage Horizon
- CTA button: Sage Horizon background with Pure Cream text

6.2 Hero Section

- Background: Gradient from Warm Sand to Pure Cream with high-quality destination image overlay (40% opacity)
- Search bar: White with Sage Horizon accent on focus
- Heading: Charcoal Depth, 48px, bold
- Subheading: Deep Ocean, 20px, medium

6.3 Cards (Flights, Hotels, Itinerary)

- Background: White with 8px border radius
- Shadow: 0px 4px 12px rgba(0,0,0,0.08) on hover
- Image: Full-width top, 200px height, rounded top corners
- Price badge: Terracotta Dusk background, white text
- CTA: Sage Horizon button with hover transition to Deep Ocean

6.4 Interactive Map

- Map container: White background with Mocha Neutral border
- Markers: Sage Horizon pins with white icons
- Route lines: Terracotta Dusk, 3px width, dashed
- Info cards: White with soft shadow, Soft Lavender accent border on hotel

6.5 Checklist

- Container: Warm Sand background with rounded corners
- Checkbox: Sage Horizon when checked, Mocha Neutral border unchecked
- Items: Charcoal Depth text, strikethrough when complete
- Progress bar: Sage Horizon fill, Warm Sand background

6.6 Flowchart (D2)

- Node background: Soft Lavender with white text
- Active node: Sage Horizon with white text and subtle glow
- Decision nodes: Terracotta Dusk for yes/no branches
- Connecting lines: Deep Ocean, 2px

7. Layout Structure

Homepage Layout:

- Hero section with gradient background and search bar (60vh)
- Featured destinations cards (3-column grid on desktop)
- How it works section with icons and micro-interactions
- Trust signals (reviews, bookings, destinations)
- Footer with official links and resources

Dashboard Layout:

- Left panel: D2 flowchart (30% width, sticky)
- Center panel: Questionnaire wizard (40% width)
- Right panel: Live checklist and status (30% width, sticky)
- Bottom drawer: Flights, hotels, map results (expandable)

8. Micro-interactions & Animation

- Button hover: Smooth scale (1.02x) with 200ms ease
- Card hover: Elevation increase with shadow transition
- Checklist check: Checkmark animation with bounce effect
- Flowchart transitions: Fade and highlight active path
- Tab switching: Slide transition (300ms) with fade
- Loading states: Sage Horizon spinner with pulse animation

9. Responsive Breakpoints

Device	Breakpoint	Layout Changes
Mobile	< 640px	Stack all panels vertically, collapsible flowchart, bottom nav
Tablet	640-1024px	2-column layout, side drawer for flowchart, stacked checklist
Desktop	> 1024px	3-panel layout as specified, sticky sidebar elements

10. Design Summary

This design specification creates a unique, modern travel planning experience that balances visual sophistication with practical usability. The color palette of elevated neutrals and soft jewel tones creates a calm, trustworthy atmosphere inspired by luxury travel sites and 2026 UI trends. The layout prioritizes clarity with the flowchart-questionnaire-checklist structure, while micro-interactions and smooth transitions make the experience feel polished and responsive. Background gradients and strategic use of white space guide the user's attention without overwhelming them, creating an aesthetic that feels both modern and timeless.